

Tacit Knowledge at AUI

Affinity diagram · 94 notes from 8 interviews

INTERVIEWEES

Omar Bensaid OM — transfer, CS

Mehdi Ouahbi ME — Business

Haytam Idrissi HA — senior, Robotics Club pres.

COLLECTED BY HAYTAM (TEAMMATE)

Interviewee A MA — anonymous, short answers

Interviewee B HZ — anonymous, junior SSE mentor

COLLECTED BY ANASS (TEAMMATE)

Mehdi Ben Touhami MT — Business, 3rd yr

Mohammed Bouhlal MB — CS, 3rd yr

Youssef Aïtch YA — CS, 2nd yr

TEAM: FAROUK (OM/ME/HA SETS BELOW), MANAL, HAYTAM, ANASS — 4 MEMBERS

What's written down isn't what actually happens

12 notes

OM4Two weeks to learn two grading systems exist

OM9Missed assignment — undocumented second platform

OM10Assumed Moodle was the single source of truth

ME1Visa steps documented but real steps differ

ME2Brought listed items, turned away anyway

ME5Counter asks for something different than posted

ME7University posts the rules but doesn't check what offices actually do

ME8Gap between policy and practice — nobody's job to fix it

ME10He sees it as a system problem, not his own mistake

HA1No internal guide existed for club funding

HA2Revised funding request 3 times to pass

MT8Fined \$200/week for dorm storage — nobody explained the rule

Peers beat official channels, every time

19 notes

OM6Searched website first, out of habit

OM7AUI website had nothing useful for his specific question

OM8Lurked in WhatsApp group waiting for an answer

ME3A senior student walked him through the real process

HA3Senior from unrelated club shared the format

HZ8Trusts Facebook groups — many share same problems

HZ9Hearing from many people feels more reliable than one person's advice

HZ10Exchange Facebook group is where students find rental and housing leads

MA2Friend showed him the printer directly

MA5Peer explained exchange/study-abroad options

MT6Assigned Mentor is his first stop for any question

MT7Trusts Mentor, Facebook, seniors — they're "further along"

MB2Asked Sidra, a student who'd already been on exchange

MB3Sidra showed him the real documents and steps needed

MB4No formal tool — goes straight to Facebook or a known contact

MB5Trusted Sidra because she'd lived the exact process herself

MB7Researched it himself before advisors ever mentioned it

YA6Trusts upperclassmen most — "they have the info 100% correct"

YA7Admin offices often don't give a complete or accurate answer

Knowledge lives in one head, leaves with it

12 notes

OM11Course-specific debug tricks only exist in a few students' heads

OM12That knowledge disappears when they graduate — IT support doesn't cover it

ME4Learned to arrive early, bring extra copies

ME6Has since repeated the same walkthrough for two other students

HA6Started a Google Doc to write down the funding process, but it's incomplete

HA7The doc is in his personal Drive — his successor probably won't find it

HA8Privately knows which advisors actually help

HA9Which advisors are good — that info leaves when he graduates

HA10"Institutional knowledge lives in people, not in any system"

HA11Even his attempt to write things down failed — no official place to put it

MB12Trailed off on "what disappears" — then agreed: admin know-how

YA9Uses Outlook + Canvas syllabus as his own go-to when answering others

Expected to already know, so stayed quiet

5 notes

OM1Not "new-new" but knows nothing about AUI

OM2Others assume he already knows things

OM3Didn't ask — might "sound obvious"

OM5Transfers get 30 min on credits but no walkthrough of daily campus life

ME9Advises: find another student who's been through it before going to any office alone

Nobody teaches you the physical campus

7 notes

HZ1Campus very confusing — no map provided

HZ2Trouble identifying buildings

HZ3Would get food off campus, then get lost finding the way back to dorm

HZ4Finding classrooms and buildings is still the hardest thing to figure out

MB1First struggle was just finding a building — no official process

YA1Couldn't figure out where his classes were physically located

YA2Solved it by asking staff at the "Open Doors" help desk

Rumors travel fast, trust has to be earned

5 notes

HZ11Believed a rumor that scholarships get revoked for failing — turned out false

HZ12Learned from that: "you can't always trust what other students say"

HZ14Now advises new students: always verify info, don't just trust rumors

HZ17Trusts peers for how-to questions (printing, paying) but not for opinions

YA8Add/Drop Facebook group exists but "isn't 100% trustworthy"

AI and anonymous crowds before people

4 notes

MA3Goes to AI before asking any person or reading any document

HZ5Uses AI first for anything technical

HZ6Goes to Quora, Reddit, Substack when he wants opinions or experiences

HZ7Only asks a real person if AI and online sources aren't enough

The same questions, the same few people

6 notes

HA4New officers ask same funding question yearly

HA5Explained the format 8 or 9 times

HZ13Hears the same questions from new students over and over

MT10Constantly asked "is studying at AUI hard or not?"

MB8Now that people know he's done exchange, they all ask him how it works

YA13Constantly asked about the attendance policy — how many absences are OK

One failed test, no do-over

3 notes · new from Anass's interviews

MT1Failed a mandatory placement test given before he even arrived

MT2Wasn't allowed a retake after failing it once

MT3Failed the retake too — says it shaped his path afterward

Registration and Add/Drop confuse everyone

4 notes · new from Anass's interviews

MT5Didn't know where to find Add/Drop or next-semester registration

MB6Didn't know "undrop" needs advisor confirmation — it messed everything up

YA4Struggles to pick a class time that also matches the right professor

YA5Mentor's advice: "choose the professor, don't choose the time"

Rules you only learn by breaking them

4 notes · new from Anass's interviews

MT9Advice: "don't fight with anyone" after a fight with his roommate

YA10Broke curfew for dinner off campus — only found out the rule after

YA11Resolved it by explaining himself to the Dean of Student Affairs

YA12Learned to stay away from fights, even to break one up

Pick your major and your friends early — advice everyone repeats

6 notes · new from Anass's interviews

MT11Advice: know your strengths clearly before choosing a major

MT12Advice: choose friends carefully — they push you forward or hold you back

MB9Advice: register/declare your major right away, don't stay confused

MB10Advice: know how to pick your core courses early

MB11Advice: choose your friends well

YA14Advice: pick your major early — switching later "resets you to zero"

Parking lot

1 note · solution idea, set aside

HZ16Wishes there was a dedicated platform just for AUI students instead of generic social media

Outliers

6 notes · didn't fit any cluster

HZ15Made temporary friends during orientation but lost contact over time

MA1Couldn't think of a specific story from her first weeks

MA4Couldn't recall a specific mistake caused by missing information

MT4Tore a knee ligament during running training — personal, not a knowledge gap

MT13What he'll remember most is the cafeteria food, not "knowledge"

YA3Bucks the trend: goes straight to Admin first, not to peers